

Neighbour distinction

- Pacing / silence family distinction: TC035 Strategic Pause is the right choice only when its specific cue is present.
- | Neighbouring technique | Use instead when | Difference |
- | TC029 Strategic Silence | The live cue fits Strategic Silence more cleanly. | Leave warm space after a meaningful cue; use when silence lets them deepen rather than feel abandoned. |
- | TC031 Slow Down Under Pressure | The live cue fits Slow Down Under Pressure more cleanly. | Slow your pace under pressure; use when speed, intensity or urgency is making the exchange worse. |
- Use TC035 when: Use a deliberate one-beat pause around your own key line; use when timing will help the point land.
- Autonomy/safety guard: Use this technique to clarify, respect and connect. Do not use it to corner, flatter, extract, pressure or override someone's agency.

A strategic pause is not empty space. It is a decision not to trample the moment with extra words. The pause works best when it is brief, warm and attached to a real conv